ACME'S ECUMENICAL STANCE ON CREDENTIAL PROTOCOLS

Even though ACME issues credentials using the `did:scid` method, it designed its credential verification layer to support presentations delivered through different protocol families and a variety of DID methods. This ensures that ACME can collaborate with partners, suppliers, clinicians, and auditors, whether they use DID-based infrastructure, OpenID4VC tools, or wallet software that supports both.

At the heart of this strategy is a flexible verification service that can adapt to different protocols. This component operates within ACME's PEP layer and handles receiving presentations, validating signatures, verifying issuer trust, and checking revocation status. The verification service provides a consistent interface to the rest of ACME's authorization pipeline, even when presentations arrive through various transport methods and interaction patterns. Supporting a new VC protocol requires updating this service; it does not require rewriting policies, changing the PDP, or modifying application logic.

The trust store and issuer governance information managed by the PIP are integrated into this verification layer to ensure that protocol differences do not leak into policy. A credential presented using a DID-based method and one using an OpenID4VC flow both produce the same outcome: a set of trusted, normalized attributes that the PDP can evaluate. Policies remain centered on business meaning, not on protocol specifics.

By maintaining a protocol-neutral verification layer, ACME avoids locking itself or its partners into any single ecosystem. This flexibility enables ACME to adapt as the verifiable credential landscape changes, while maintaining a consistent and reliable authorization workflow across all its products.